



Maharatna of the nation



Maharashtra is the perfect showcase for all around development in the country. The government has pragmatic policies aimed at benefiting the “aam aadmi”. As a socially progressive state, it has been aggressively pursuing development plans and has been successfully getting the funds for the same. As a result, Maharashtra is today, the most industrialized State in the country. It boasts of the best infrastructure. No wonder, it is the economic powerhouse of the country today. It offers a favourable atmosphere for industrial investment, domestic and foreign. It is the leader in investment inflow and is poised to lead the country in the infrastructure development sector. The Democratic Front government has announced affirmative action plans for housing, infrastructure, public safety and security, women welfare, population control, development of children and industrial development. The state is devoted to securing social justice. It has given priority to programs aimed at the welfare of the weaker sections of society, minorities, farmers and farm labourers.

Q. Maharashtra is the No.1 State in the country for Industrial Investment. Why?

Maharashtra has always stayed ahead in industrialisation and investment. SEZ's and the investment thereof, mega projects as also in the fast growing sectors of IT and biotech, the state has always stayed a step ahead. The steady growth in investments and industrial growth has ensured employment for lakhs of youth. The mega project that was announced in June 2005 has been extremely successful.

Q. How many unemployed youth are expected to get jobs in the State SEZ's? Also what is the investment expected to come due to these industries?

Maharashtra has the largest number of SEZ's in the country. The 146 SEZ's represent Rs 1,88,738 crore investment and offer 65,29,958 people an expectation to get employment. The Central Government has permitted 4041 foreign investment proposals and these are expected to bring in FDI worth Rs 75,096 crore. Through a total of 416 IT Parks in the State, approximately a thousand companies are functional. These mean Rs 5000 crore investment and a generation of One Lakh jobs.



Shri. Ashok Chavan
Hon'ble Chief Minister
of Maharashtra

Q. Will the New Industrial Policy benefit the state?

New industrial investment will definitely benefit the small and medium industries in the state. Till November 2008 last year about 19,000 such new businesses have started. This proves that Maharashtra is the only state in the country that offers employment on a large scale, and shall continue to do so in the future.

Q. “Maharashtra is the Gateway of India for Investment.” Would you please elaborate?

If you track the industrial investment coming into the country, you will realize that Maharashtra comes up as the “Gateway”. One-fourth of the investment coming into the country is directed towards Maharashtra. Also of the country's exports, 25% have been manufactured in Maharashtra. With 147 mega projects in Maharashtra, a substantial Rs 1,28,813 crore investment, employment for around 2 lakh people is expected.

Q. Could you tell us about the Information Technology sector in the State?

Over 90% of the country's IT sectors are spread over seven cities like Mumbai-Pune. According to NASSCOM report,